drew from the identical actions of the French anarchist Auguste Vaillant in 1893. He too had thrown a weak home-made device from the public gallery in the French Chamber of Deputies. His action caused only slight injuries to twenty deputies. He too had wanted only 'to make the deaf hear' in revenge for the execution of the fellow anarchist Ravachol. At his execution by guillotine, Vaillant had boldly proclaimed, 'Long live anarchy!' Bhagat Singh too employed the slogan '*Inquilab zindabad*' at his trial. And if Vaillant in 1893 wanted to cause maximum shock with minimum damage, then so too did Bhagat Singh in 1929. The fact that Bhagat Singh did not wish to cause physical injury to anyone but merely to draw attention to the iniquity of the two bills being passed showed how sophisticated and trailblazing he was when barely out of his teenage years.

Bhagat Singh's second act, however, did cause death. But it was deliberately calculated to do so to restore the honour of Punjab. It arose from the police beating and death of Lala Lajpat Rai. This had to be avenged, so an assassination was planned. Lala Lajpat Rai was no minor figure but a towering giant of the Independence Movement. He belonged to the trinity of early revolutionary leaders known as 'Bal, Pal, Lal', who consisted of *Bal* Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra *Pal* and *Lala* Lajpat Rai. All three had broken away from the Congress Party. Affectionately called '*Punjab Kesari*', Lala Lajpat Rai ('Lalaji') had set up the National College in Bradlaugh Hall to provide an alternative education centre to British institutions. When Lalaji was killed by police batons in what had been a peaceful demonstration, Bhagat Singh had to act. The policeman J.P. Saunders was shot on 17 December 1929 to avenge the death of Lalaji. It was a revenge attack. Immediately after the attack, the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association published a notice signed off by Bhagat Singh in which he described the assassination as a 'retaliatory action of none but a decisive nature' for the 'most dastardly attack made on the great old man of India' which 'hereby is avenged'. It was therefore as clear in its intent of settling a score as it was decisive.

This is how the shooting of J.P. Saunders was designed to salvage the honour of the people. Yet, Bhagat Singh was not left untouched by the